Development

(i) Internal fertilization takes place. This is followed by cocoon formation. **Cocoon** is also known as **egg case** which is formed around the 9th, 10th and 11th segments.

(ii) Development is direct and proceeds in cocoon which contain one to 24 embryos.

(iii) Young leech resembling the adult emerges.

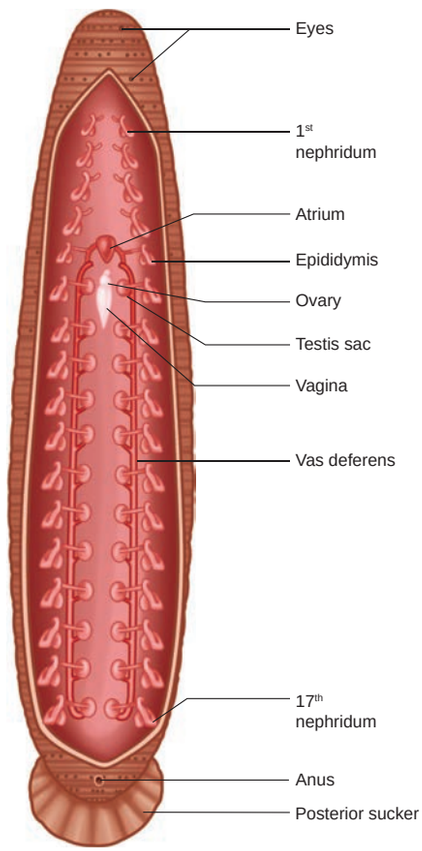


Figure 13.4 Reproductive system of Leech

More to Know

Medicinal value of Leech

Leeches are effective in increasing blood circulation and breaking up blood clots. It is surprising that they can be used to treat cardiovascular diseases. Biochemical substances derived from leech saliva are used for preparation of pharmaceutical drugs that can treat hypertension.

13.1.12 Parasitic Adaptations of Leech

Leeches lead a parasitic mode of life by sucking the blood of vertebrates and show several important adaptations in their structure.

1. Blood is sucked by pharynx.
2. Anterior and posterior ends of the body are provided with suckers by which the animal attaches itself to the body of the host.
3. The three jaws inside the mouth, causes a painless Y-shaped wound in the skin of the host.
4. The salivary glands produce hirudin which does not allow the blood to coagulate. Thus, a continuous supply of the blood is maintained.
5. Parapodia and setae are completely absent
6. Blood is stored in the crop. It gives nourishment to the leech for several months. Due to this reason there is no elaborate secretion of the digestive juices and enzymes.

DO YOU KNOW?

Blood letting is a technique of bleeding in a patient to remove toxic impurities from the body.

13.2 Rabbit (*Oryctolagus cuniculus*)

Taxonomic Position	
Phylum	Chordata
Sub-phylum	Vertebrata
Class	Mammalia
Order	Lagomorpha
Genus	*Oryctolagus*
Species	*cuniculus*

13.2.1 Habit and Habitat

Rabbits are gentle and timid animals. They show leaping movement and live in burrows.

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